a FlexLifeFi K-12 program

Cash & Company

TEACHER PD · MODULE 05

Differentiation in Practice

Concrete scaffolds for ELL, IEP/504, and advanced - by band.

Differentiate the path, not the outcome. Same destination, different paths. The 30-second scaffold menu, grade-band by grade-band.

CONTENTS

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Concrete scaffolds for ELL, IEP/504, and advanced - by band.

01 What this module is for /

02 The bedrock principles (apply to all populations, all bands) /

03 ELL — concrete scaffolds by band /

04 IEP / 504 — concrete scaffolds by band /

05 Advanced learners — concrete scaffolds by band /

06 The 30-second scaffold menu /

07 What differentiation is NOT /

08 Module 05 knowledge check /

09 Activity tie-ins /

10 Module 05 — answers to the knowledge check /

> A student who is given a fluffier outcome has been failed twice.

Module length: ~20 minutes **Activities to do alongside:** Activity 9 (Scaffold Menu Build), Activity 10 (Differentiation Trio Plan) **Walkaway move:** a grade-band-specific scaffold menu you can pull from in 30 seconds.

What this module is for

Differentiation is the difference between a curriculum that works in theory and a curriculum that works in your classroom — the one with three students on IEPs, two newcomer English Language Learners, four students reading two grades above level, and one student who has been quietly checked-out since October.

Cash to Company is built for that classroom. The differentiation guidance baked into every lesson is concrete, not platitude. This module unpacks that guidance — by population, by band — and gives you a working menu of scaffolds so you can pull what you need when you need it.

The three populations the program names explicitly:

- **English Language Learners (ELL)** — students whose home language is not English, at any proficiency level from newcomer to nearly-fluent.
- **IEP / 504** — students with documented learning differences, accommodations, or disabilities.
- **Advanced** — students working above grade-level, or in need of additional challenge to stay engaged.

This module gives concrete, grade-by-grade scaffolds for each. None of it is "give them a worksheet." All of it is specific.

The bedrock principles (apply to all populations, all bands)

Three rules govern Cash differentiation. Internalize them; they make the band-specific moves easier to apply.

1. Differentiate the path, not the outcome. Every student arrives at the same strand outcome (e.g., "interview a customer and produce a 1-paragraph summary"). The path varies — language, tools, time, partner support. The destination does not. This is the program's commitment to high expectations for all.

2. Use the multi-modal pathway already built into the curriculum. Every Cash lesson has a video, a transcript, a discussion, an activity, a journal, and an artifact. A student who can't access one mode can usually access another. Differentiation is often a matter of redirecting which mode carries the lesson for which student — not adding a new mode.

3. The Capstone arc is the great equalizer. Long-arc work over short-burst work. A student who is below pace on Tuesday's quick-check has nine months to demonstrate the strand outcome

through the Capstone. The Capstone allows for slow build, multiple revisions, and a wide range of demonstrations of the same skill.

ELL — concrete scaffolds by band

K-2 ELL

Newcomers and partial-English learners in K-2 may have rich oral vocabulary in their home language but limited English. Lean into this.

- **Picture-first sorting.** Every K-2 Cash activity has a sort component (Make/Do, Helper/Customer, Need/Want). Make the sort cards picture-only for any student who can't yet read. The sorting demonstrates the strand outcome; the words can be added later.
- **Home-language home-story.** When a kid is naming a "helper they know," let them tell the story in their home language to a peer or parent volunteer who shares the language. The teacher records the English translation.
- **Repetition is friendly (lean in).** K-2 Cash already uses repetition. ELL students benefit from more. Repeat the spine question — "What did you see?" — in three different sentence frames across a 5-minute span.
- **Realia.** Bring real objects. A real coin. A real receipt. A real apple from the cafeteria. Real objects bypass the language barrier and anchor the lesson.
- **Sample line:** "What did the helper do? Show me with your hands. Or tell your partner. Or draw it."

3-5 ELL

Students at this band are usually building reading fluency in English. Vocabulary load is the biggest barrier; conceptual understanding is often ahead of language production.

- **Cognate watch.** Many Cash 3-5 vocabulary words have cognates in Spanish, French, and other Romance languages — customer / cliente, profit / profit, problem / problema, plan / plan. Name them. Encourage students to use the cognate when stuck.
- **Sentence frames.** Provide a frame the student fills in. "My idea is _. The customer is _. They will pay _ because _."
- **Pre-watch the Cash video with subtitles in home language.** The Cash videos already have English captions; many also have transcripts that translate cleanly. Send the link home the day before.
- **Pair with a bilingual buddy** — sparingly, and never as the only access to instruction. The buddy shouldn't be the de facto translator for the year.
- **Sample line:** "You picked this idea — how do you know somebody actually wants it? You can answer in any language. Then we'll write it in English together."

6-8 ELL

The vocabulary load increases sharply at this band — contribution margin, persona, segmentation, A/B test. The conceptual challenge is real; the language challenge can be managed.

- **Frayer model the weight-bearing terms.** Cash to Company already prescribes Frayer models for terms like contribution margin, customer, persona. ELL students should do these in pairs with sentence-frame support.
- **Math without prose.** When the math is the lesson (Unit 2 of Grade 7), let the student do the math first and write the prose explanation second. Math is more universal than English.
- **Interview the customer in any language.** A customer-interview project doesn't require English. Encourage students to interview customers in the customer's preferred language and translate findings.
- **Translate the canonical phrases.** "Which people, and how do you know?" translates cleanly. Pin the home-language version next to the English on the wall.
- **Sample line:** "Revenue is loud. Contribution margin is true. Compute one number. The number is in any language."

9-12 ELL

Late-arriving ELL students at this band — newcomers in high school — are often dealing with high cognitive demand in a language they're still acquiring. The program respects the cognitive demand and adjusts the language scaffold.

- **Glossary at the back.** Every 9-12 Curriculum Book has a vocabulary roadmap — turn it into a glossary handout for ELL students with home-language translations where possible.
- **Long-form to short-form translation.** A high-school Cash lesson might require a 1-page memo. Allow the ELL student to produce a bullet-list draft in English (or in their home language) first, then a 1-paragraph English version with peer support.
- **Capstone in any language at draft stage.** The final defense is in English; the drafting can happen in any language. Translation comes at the polish stage, not the thinking stage.
- **Sample line:** "You can pick what kind of business you build. It's a choice. Tell me about your choice in whichever language you can think most clearly in. We'll get it into English for the defense."

IEP / 504 — concrete scaffolds by band

K-2 IEP/504

Common IEPs at this band: speech-language, fine motor, attention, autism spectrum, early-reading. Cash K-2 is already heavily multi-modal — drawing, dramatic play, talking, sorting — which is friendly to most accommodations.

- **Drawing is a valid demonstration.** A K-2 student who can't yet write can still demonstrate the Make/Do sort by drawing. Drawing-based artifacts go in the Capstone Journal.
- **Adult scribe option.** Always available; never a punishment. "You can tell me your idea, and I'll write what you say."
- **Movement breaks built into long activities.** The four-corners activity and gallery walk are movement-friendly; lean into them for students with attention or sensory needs.
- **Sensory-friendly Cash.** Cash videos run 2:30–3:00, captioned, never high-contrast neon, never sudden loud audio. They are designed for sensory-friendly classrooms by default.

3-5 IEP/504

Common IEPs: dyslexia, ADHD, executive function, autism spectrum, language-processing, math (dyscalculia).

- **Read-aloud option for any text.** The Cash videos themselves are the read-aloud version of the curriculum content. Use them for students with reading needs.
- **Chunked task lists.** Break a 30-minute project into five 6-minute steps with checkboxes. The Cash to Company Activity Book templates already do this.
- **Manipulatives for math.** Grade 5 introduces price-cost-profit math. For students with dyscalculia, provide physical coins and manipulatives. Don't require mental math.
- **Predictable structure.** The Cash to Company weekly rhythm (Monday opener, Wednesday long block, Friday Showcase + Stuck) is the same every week. Predictability helps students with autism, anxiety, and executive-function needs.

6-8 IEP/504

Common IEPs at this band: executive function, ADHD, dyslexia, dyscalculia, autism, anxiety, mood disorders.

- **Capstone can be a partnered or small-group project for any student whose IEP names group accommodations.** Many do.
- **Calculator allowed for all contribution-margin work.** The skill is the concept, not arithmetic accuracy.
- **The Showcase + Stuck routine is a built-in support.** A student who is "stuck" gets class help. That structure is anxiety-friendly because it normalizes being stuck.
- **Reduced-load options for the Capstone Defense.** A 5-minute defense to a small panel is a valid alternative to a full-class defense for a student with social anxiety.

9-12 IEP/504

Common IEPs: executive function, ADHD, dyslexia, anxiety, depression, autism, transition planning. The program also lands at this band with student counselors actively working on post-secondary planning.

- **The Capstone is the work, not a checklist.** A student with executive-function needs can use a calendar template (provided) to break the Capstone into weekly milestones.
- **Speech-to-text for written defenses.** Allowed; common; many students benefit.
- **Alternative defense formats.** Video-recorded defense, written defense, defense to a small panel, defense to a single judge. All are valid; all are pre-cleared with the school's IEP/504 process.
- **Real-venture work requires explicit IEP/504 coordination.** Grade 11 and 12 students who pursue real customer-facing work need their IEP/504 team to sign off — see `REAL_VENTURE_READINESS_CHECKLIST.md`.

Advanced learners — concrete scaffolds by band

K-2 ADVANCED

Children who are reading well above grade level, doing math above grade level, or simply asking deep questions.

- **The "Cash side question."** When the lesson is "what did the helper do?", the advanced K-2 student can take the side question: "And what did the helper need to do their job?"
- **Mentor-other-students.** A K-2 child who has finished the sort can teach the sort to a neighbor. Teaching is the highest-rigor demonstration.
- **A second, harder Capstone artifact.** "You finished the make/do sort. Now: which job is harder, making or doing? Show me with two examples."

3-5 ADVANCED

- **Real-world data.** Pull a real product page or a real menu. Have the advanced student calculate prices, costs, and possible profit using real numbers.
- **Capstone goes deeper, not wider.** An advanced 4th-grader doesn't need a bigger business plan; they need a more honest business plan. Push on the spine question: which people, and how do you know? Twice as hard.
- **Cross-band conferring.** An advanced 5th-grader can shadow a Grade 6 or 7 lesson once or twice. The vertical alignment is intentional.

6-8 ADVANCED

- **Real customer interviews.** An advanced 7th-grader can interview real customers (with parental consent) and produce a real persona pack. The Cash framework is built to handle real-world data; let advanced students play in it.

- **Optional financial-modeling extension.** A 7th-grader who has mastered contribution margin can extend to break-even analysis and a 3-month cash projection. Materials are in the Grade 8 / Grade 9 books.
- **Premortem early.** The premortem is a Grade 9 concept; an advanced 8th-grader can run one informally on their Capstone.

9-12 ADVANCED

- **Real customers, real money — with the readiness checklist.** An advanced 11th- or 12th-grader can pursue real customer-facing pilots with actual revenue. The `REAL_VENTURE_READINESS_CHECKLIST.md` is the gate. Don't bypass it.
- **External mentor pairing.** A Grade 11 or 12 advanced student can be paired with a community business mentor (vetted by the school). The mentor offers monthly conferring.
- **Cross-disciplinary deepening.** A 12th-grade advanced student can connect Cash to Company work to AP courses (Statistics, Economics, Computer Science). The Capstone Defense panel can include AP teachers.

The 30-second scaffold menu

When a kid in front of you needs differentiation right now, pull from this menu. Match the population to the band, then pick one:

```
 ELL
  K-2: Picture sort. Realia. Repetition.
  3-5: Cognate hunt. Sentence frame. Bilingual buddy.
  6-8: Frayer model. Math first. Translate the canonical phrases.
  9-12: Glossary handout. Draft in any language. Polish in English.

IEP/504
  K-2: Drawing as artifact. Adult scribe. Movement breaks.
  3-5: Read-aloud (Cash video). Chunked task list. Manipulatives.
  6-8: Calculator allowed. Showcase+Stuck normalizes being stuck. Reduced-load defense.
  9-12: Calendar template. Speech-to-text. Alternative defense format.

Advanced
  K-2: Side question. Mentor a neighbor. Harder artifact.
  3-5: Real-world data. Deeper not wider. Cross-band shadow.
  6-8: Real customer interviews. Financial modeling extension. Early premortem.
  9-12: Real customer pilot (with checklist). External mentor. Cross-disciplinary.
```

Tape this inside your plan book.

What differentiation is NOT

Three patterns Cash refuses:

1. Tracking. No "high group," "middle group," "low group" sections of the room. The Capstone is a year-long project; it does not segregate.

2. Lower expectations as a kindness. A student who is given a fluffier outcome because the teacher worried they couldn't reach the real one has been failed twice — once by the school system and once by the teacher. The differentiation is in the path. The destination is the strand outcome.

3. The "helper" treatment. A student does not need to be infantilized to be supported. ELL students are not "the kids who don't speak English." IEP students are not "the kids who can't." Advanced students are not "the kids who finish first." Names, faces, specific scaffolds — that is the differentiation move. Vague labels, lower expectations, separate tasks — that is failure.

Module 05 knowledge check

1. State the three populations Cash differentiation explicitly addresses.
2. State the bedrock rule about differentiation paths and outcomes.
3. Pick one band and one population. Name two concrete scaffolds.
4. Name one pattern Cash differentiation refuses.

Activity tie-ins

- **Activity 9 (Scaffold Menu Build):** Build your own 30-second scaffold menu, customized to your specific classroom roster.
- **Activity 10 (Differentiation Trio Plan):** Pick one Cash lesson plan. Plan three concrete scaffolds — one ELL, one IEP/504, one advanced. Compare with a peer.

Module 05 — answers to the knowledge check

1. ELL, IEP/504, Advanced.
2. Differentiate the path, not the outcome.
3. (Many valid answers — see the band tables.)
4. Tracking; lower expectations; infantilizing scaffolds. Any one is correct.

One promise.

A student who is given a fluffier outcome has been failed twice.

Cash to Company is built so a curriculum coordinator, a foundation officer, a parent, or a teacher can pick up any one of these strategic references and meet the program at full strength on the first page.

No promise of wealth. No probing of family finances. No partisan content. One question, asked patiently for thirteen years: which people, and how do you know?

For educational and operational use. This document is informational and does not constitute financial, legal, or tax advice. Standards alignment is cited per the Cash to Company Standards Alignment Map (Jump$tart, CEE, CCSS, C3, CASEL, NGSS-ETS).